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No more "Hot-Cheetos": California bans them

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Seeking to improve the health and well-being of students, California legislators approved a bill to prohibit the sale of foods containing food dyes, among them the famous "Hot-Cheetos".

The measure, which will take effect in 2028, will prevent the distribution of those products within the state's public schools.

The California government's measure The state of California will begin taking these measures due to growing concerns about children's health in the territory, where studies have connected certain dyes with developed behavioral problems such as hyperactivity and inattention.

Lawmakers and health advocates argue that these additives can interfere with children's ability to learn and that they deserve healthier foods in their schools.

All foods containing dyes such as Red 40, Yellow 5, Yellow 6, Blue 1, Blue 2 and Green 3 would be banned in school.

Only Governor Gavin Newsom's signature is expected to complete the measure that will affect snacks such as Flamin Hot Cheetos along with other products:

The purpose of the measure

Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel, D-Encino and author of the bill, has stressed that these synthetic ingredients are "dangerous" and "harm our children, interfering with their ability to learn." According to Gabriel, state studies have linked these dyes to hyperactivity and neurological behavioral problems in children. "The issue of food safety is and should be bipartisan," Gabriel said before the final vote, which passed the Assembly with 55 votes in favor and none against.

Mixed reactions

The bill has received bipartisan support and has the backing of doctors, teachers and agricultural groups who see the measure as a necessary step to protect children's health. However, not everyone agrees. Industry groups representing candy manufacturers have strongly opposed it, arguing that the bill exceeds the authority of the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA). The Consumer Brand Association stated, "All of these additives have been thoroughly reviewed by federal and state systems and many international scientific bodies and continue to be considered safe."

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